Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣2

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠10

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥8

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 5 3 ♥ A 10 9 5 2 ♦ A 9 4 ♣ A 4	
♠ 8 7 4 ♥ 8 3 ♦ K J 10 7 2 ♣ 7 6 2		♠ Q J 10 9 ♥ 6 4 ♦ Q 8 5 3 ♣ 8 5 3
	♠ A 6 2 ♥ K Q J 7 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J 10 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	7♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings

7♥ by North
Lead: ♠Q

When SOUTH answers Blackwood with one Ace NORTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, SOUTH would bid 6♥. But she knows that if she does so, NORTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, SOUTH figures her ♣ suit will supply five tricks so she bids 7♥.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 6 2 ♥ 10 8 ♦ A 7 4 3 ♣ 7 5 4	
♠ 8 7 ♥ Q 9 7 4 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ A 10 8 3		♠ A K Q 5 ♥ A J 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J
	♠ 9 4 3 ♥ K 3 ♦ J 10 9 8 2 ♣ 9 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by East
Lead: ♣2

EAST thinks there might be slam if WEST holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When WEST shows just one Ace EAST is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so he stops at 5♥.

It turns out that EAST might make twelve tricks, depending on the ♥K situation.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K 4 2 ♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2 ♦ K ♣ K 3	
♠ Q 10 9 8 ♥ 10 9 ♦ J 8 7 4 ♣ J 6 5	N W E S	♠ 7 5 3 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 10 9 5 3 ♣ Q 10 8 2
	♠ A J 6 ♥ K 5 ♦ A Q 6 2 ♣ A 9 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam in ♥s. He chooses to temporize with a 1♥ response and is rewarded when SOUTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents NORTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine. When he discovers that SOUTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 9 4 ♥ 9 8 5 3 2 ♦ A 8 7 ♣ 9 2	
♠ Q 6 3 ♥ A 10 7 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ A 10 8 6		♠ A K ♥ K Q 4 ♦ K Q J 3 ♣ K Q J 5
	♠ 10 8 7 5 2 ♥ J 6 ♦ 10 6 4 ♣ 7 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♠	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♥8

WEST responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

EAST only needs to know how many Aces are in the WEST hand. He must use Gerber since 4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When WEST shows two Aces EAST bids 6NT.